



Social Psychology (SOCPSY)

Module 6: Attitudes, Conformity and Obedience

Conformity, Obedience and Resistance

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

Version: 2026

Conformity

Conformity is changing behaviour or belief to match a group. Asch's work showed that people sometimes give wrong answers to fit the group. On campus, a student may agree with a dominant tutorial opinion even while disagreeing privately.

Obedience and Compliance

Obedience is following direct orders from an authority. Compliance is going along with a request. Authority can be useful for safety rules. It becomes harmful when it overrides ethical judgment. Students need both respect for legitimate rules and the skill to question harmful orders.

Resisting Harmful Influence

Pause and name the pressure. Find one ally who also doubts the group. Ask for the reason behind a request. Keep personal ethical lines clear in advance. These steps increase the chance of independent judgment.

Reflect: Which resistance step feels most realistic for you: naming the pressure, finding an ally, or asking for reasons?

Closing

Module 6 completes Social Psychology. Pass the graded quizzes and check your dashboard for certificate status.